

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

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KHAMARI J. THORPE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE
OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE
OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875,
POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and
JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet
unidentified,

Defendants.

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TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANT:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in the case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded herein.

Defendant's address:

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, New York 10007

POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER
STELMACH-Shield #19816
Tax ID # 966870
c/o New York City Police Department- 75th
Precinct
1000 Sutter Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11208

POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield
07304
Tax ID # 954922
c/o New York City Police Department- 75th
Precinct
1000 Sutter Avenue
Brooklyn, New York 11208

Index #

Date of filing:

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial

SUMMONS

Basis of the venue is Locus of
Occurrence

Locus of Occurrence at
330 Hinsdale Street
Brooklyn, New York 11207

County of Kings

Plaintiff's attorneys:

RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
26 Court Street, Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718)522-1020

Defendant's address:

POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-
Shield # 05875

Tax ID # 975700

c/o New York City Police Department- 75th

Precinct

1000 Sutter Avenue

Brooklyn, New York 11208

POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #
02610

Tax ID # 965910

c/o New York City Police Department- 75th

Precinct

1000 Sutter Avenue

Brooklyn, New York 11208

Dated: Brooklyn, New York
May 15, 2024

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS-----X
KHAMARI J. THORPE,

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE
OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE
OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875,
POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and
JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet
unidentified,

Defendants.

-----X

Plaintiff, by his attorneys, RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS., complaining of the defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully shows to this Court, and alleges as follows:

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR ASSAULT
AND BATTERY ON BEHALF OF KHAMARI J. THORPE**

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the plaintiff was and still is a resident of the County of Kings, City and State of New York.
2. That all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and still is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing pursuant to the laws of the State of New York.
3. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, maintains a police force known as the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.
4. That prior hereto on August 29, 2023, and within the time prescribed by law, a sworn Notice of Claim stating, among other things, the time when and place where the injuries and damages were sustained, together with plaintiff's demands for adjustment or payment thereof, was served and that thereafter THE CITY OF NEW YORK, refused or neglected for more than

(30) days and up to the commencement of this action to make any adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter, and within the time provided by law, this action was commenced.

5. Pursuant to the General Municipal Law, the Statutory 50-H Hearing of the plaintiff was held on April 4, 2024.

6. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, employed POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, as police officers, agents, servants and/or employees.

7. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, was lawfully present at or about the premises known as 330 Hinsdale Street, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

8. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, while at the aforementioned location, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, was approached and was assaulted and battered by the defendants, POLICE POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified. The assault and battery consisted of being grabbed, thrown to the ground, kicked, thrown against a gate, struck with knees in the back and was forcefully placed in tight handcuffs. While in handcuffs, the plaintiff was dragged on the ground by defendants police officers. Thereafter, the plaintiff was placed in a police vehicle and was taken to the 75th Precinct where he was placed in a holding cell for a period of time. While in the holding cell, the plaintiff was denied timely medical attention for treatment of his injuries. The following day, June 7, 2023 at approximately 10:00 AM, the plaintiff was transported to Kings County Central Booking. He remained until he was arraigned and then released on his own recognizance at approximately 5:00

PM.

9. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, was assaulted and battered by defendants, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at the aforesaid location.

10. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the aforementioned assault and battery was performed knowingly, intentionally and willfully.

11. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who committed the aforementioned assault and battery upon the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

12. That on June 6, 2023, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the assault and battery on the plaintiff was without probable cause and was not the result of an appropriate arrest.

13. By reason of said assault and battery the plaintiff was caused to suffer severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of the person, and suffered great pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

14. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENT
HIRING AND RETENTION ON BEHALF OF KHAMARI J. THORPE**

15. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "14" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

16. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, did not exercise reasonable care and diligence in the selection, engagement, employment and training of their police officers, agents, servants, and employees and were negligent in the hiring, training and retention of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, who assaulted, battered and violated the civil rights of the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE.

17. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, had prior knowledge of the inappropriate, unlawful, and improper conduct of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, and continued to employ them and allowed them to be in contact with the public at large.

18. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR INTENTIONAL
AND NEGLIGENT INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL DISTRESS
ON BEHALF OF KHAMARI J. THORPE**

19. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "18" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at

length herein.

20. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, acted intentionally, recklessly and with utter disregard to the consequences of their actions and caused severe emotional distress to the plaintiff through their actions.

21. Said actions exceeded all reasonable bounds of decency, were outrageous and shocking and resulted in severe emotional distress to the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE.

22. That as a result of said intentional and negligent acts, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, become sick, sore, lame and disabled, received severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of his person and suffered great physical pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

23. By reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR CIVIL
RIGHTS VIOLATION ON BEHALF OF KHAMARI J. THORPE**

24. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "23" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

25. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through policies, practices and customs, directly caused the constitutional violation suffered by plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE.

26. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has had and still has hiring practices that it knows will lead to the hiring of the police officers, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA

ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, lacking the intellectual capacity and moral fortitude to discharge their duties in accordance with the constitution and is indifferent to the consequences.

27. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, through its police department, has *de facto quota* policy that encourages unlawful stops, unlawful searches, false arrests, the fabrication of evidence and perjury.

28. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was, upon information and belief, aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, routinely commit constitutional violations such as those at issue here and has failed to change its policies, practices and customs to stop this behavior.

29. The defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, at all relevant times, was aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield #07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield #05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield #02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, are unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein and/or have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct.

30. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
PUNITIVE DAMAGES ON BEHALF OF KHAMARI J. THORPE**

31. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above

numbered "1" through "30" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

32. The actions of the defendants herein-above alleged, were malicious, willful and grossly negligent.

33. That the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, authorized, permitted and ratified the unlawful and negligent acts of their agents, servants and/or employees, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER CHRISTOPHER STELMACH-Shield #19816, POLICE OFFICER LESTER HAYNES-Shield # 07304, POLICE OFFICER ROODMYLA ONEELL-Shield # 05875, POLICE OFFICER JAMES ZEBRO-Shield # 02610 and JOHN AND JANE DOES-Police Officers as yet unidentified, herein-above alleged.

34. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **First** Cause of Action; plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Second** Cause of Action; plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Third** Cause of Action; plaintiff, plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Fourth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, KHAMARI J. THORPE, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower

Courts on the **Fifth** Cause of Action; together with attorneys' fees, and the costs and disbursements of this action.

DATED: Brooklyn, New York
May 15, 2024

Yours, etc.


ROBERT MIJUCA, ESQ.
RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
KHAMARI J. THORPE
26 Court Street Suite 1200
Brooklyn, New York 11242
(718) 522-1020
File No.:23KT06-06

INDIVIDUAL VERIFICATION

STATE OF NEW YORK)

) SS:

COUNTY OF KINGS)

KHAMARI J. THORPE, being duly sworn, deposes and says, that deponent is the plaintiff in the within action; that deponent has read the foregoing COMPLAINT and knows the contents hereof; that the same is true to deponent's own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to those matters deponent believes them to be true.

Sworn to before me this 17th
of May 2024

Khamari J. Thorpe
KHAMARI J. THORPE

Magda Marin-Colon
NOTARY PUBLIC

MAGDA MARIN-COLON
Notary Public, State of New York
No. 01MA6158891
Qualified in Richmond County
Commission Expires 1-16-2027